DEREK STEPHEN MCLEAN

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Languages
- PHP
- TypeScript
- Javascript
- MySQL/MariaDB
- Bash

Frameworks
- Symfony
- Laravel
- Zend / Laminas
- NextJS
- Expo
- Vue JS
- Angular
- Ionic / Capacitor
- Bootstrap
- Tailwind

CI/ CD
- PHPUnit
- Codeception
- Pest
- Cypress
- Behat
- Selenium
- Github Actions
- GitLab CI
- Bitbucket Pipelines
- Jenkins
- PACT contract testing

APIs
- REST
- RPC
- OAuth2
- Typespec
- OpenApi

Server Side
- Linux Server Admin
- Docker
- Git
- Apache
- NginX
- RabbitMQ
- Vagrant

Professional Summary

Senior Full Stack Engineer with over 20 years of experience specialising in PHP frameworks (Symfony, Laravel, Laminas) and modern Frontend (React, React Native, Next.js, Expo). Author of the open-source Bone Framework and expert in legacy-to-modern system migrations for enterprise clients like Proximus and Marsh & McLennan.

Open Source & personal projects

Bone Framework (Author & Lead Developer)

I created a full-stack, PSR-compliant PHP framework utilising middleware and modern design patterns. It uses a modular ecosystem of packages including integrated support for Doctrine ORM, OAuth2, and OpenApi.Available via Composer/Packagist. There is also a React Native / Expo project for Android & iOS devices.

Open Source Contributions

I have made contributions to major industry-standard projects including Symfony, Composer, Doctrine, and Laminas (formerly Zend Framework). I also enjoy attending PHP conferences, to learn the newest tech developments.

Personal Projects

- Mordor MUD - I have built and am currently launching a cross-platform mobile game for iOS and Android using Expo and React Native. The app acts as a modern, polished telnet client for the long-standing mordormud.net community.
- Open Mic Stage Manager - I developed a real-time event management platform featuring Google OAuth2 sign in and automated performer check-in via QR code scanning. Implemented a dynamic "Now Playing / Up Next" display system tailored for live music and comedy venues.
- Corona QR check in system - During lockdown I built a free QR based check in system for cafes and pubs, which worked cross-venue. It was used by several business, both in Scotland & Belgium, and was recommended by two Scottish politicians (James Dornan MSP & Phillipa Whitford MP) to bid for the government contract (I didn't get it!)
- Bitcoin Trader - I made a trading panel that connected to the BTC-e Bitcoin exchange in order to place trades. Made long ago with jQuery calling a PHP backend.
- AI & Emerging Tech Exploration - I am currently experimenting with autonomous agent workflows and skills using the Agentzero AI Framework, using both cloud based and local models

Employment History

Senior Full Stack Engineer - Profunctional
Nov 2024 – Oct 2025

- Developed a comprehensive ERP system using a Laravel/Filament backend and a Next.js frontend, ensuring seamless data flow via an OAuth2 protected API.
- Streamlined development workflows by implementing TypeSpec for API documentation and Orval for automated frontend client generation.
- Engineered mission-critical data synchronisation with Microsoft Business Central and established a "test-first" culture using PHPUnit and Cypress within GitHub Actions pipelines.

Senior PHP Developer - Yappa
Jan 2024 – Apr 2024

Platform upgrades for https://www.acerta.be, a Symfony application running Kunstmaan CMS,

Senior PHP Developer - Roland Central Europe
Feb 2023 – Dec 2023

- Led critical platform upgrades for a diverse ecosystem of eight applications built on Symfony and Slim.
- Modernised the DevOps environment by introducing Docker-based development workflows and centralising automation through a Jenkins CI server.
- Guaranteed API reliability by implementing PACT contract testing and integrating JIRA X-Ray with automated pipelines for full-cycle quality assurance.

Senior Full Stack Developer - Anykrowd / FlowX
Jul 2022 – Jan 2023

- Engineering cross-platform mobile applications for iOS and Android using Angular, Ionic Framework, and Capacitor, designed for the HoReCa and festival industries
- Developing a dedicated desktop application using Electron to expand product accessibility and functionality.

- Creating a centralised multi-tenant Laravel administrative panel and API to serve as the backend.

Senior PHP Developer - Easyfairs
Mar 2021 – May 2022

Platform upgrades for a Symfony API, upgrading PHP and packages, refactoring legacy code, writing unit tests, creating a Docker based dev environment, developing new features. Front end work in Vue JS and React.

Technical Lead - Marsh & McLennan
Nov 2018 – Apr 2020

- Directed the global migration of enterprise legacy systems from PHP 5 to PHP 7, significantly improving performance and security standards.
- Coordinated international development teams across multiple countries to deliver unified architectural solutions.
- Strengthened security infrastructure through the implementation of OAuth2 Single Sign-On (SSO) across the organisation's platform.

Senior PHP Developer - Proximus
Apr 2018 – Sep 2018

Developing several new websites in Symfony, implementing OAuth2 single sign on, GDPR script management, and SOAP client

Senior PHP Developer - Kunstmaan / Accenture Interactive
Oct 2017 – Mar 2018
Developing an API for smartphone apps and websites to connect to, developing and maintaining their open source CMS framework built on Symfony

Senior PHP Developer - Tech Mahindra / Orange
Mar 2016 – Sep 2017
Upgrading Mobistar/Orange legacy telephone contract system from PHP 5 to PHP7, also designing and implementing solutions to existing architectural/ coding issues to improve performance and speed.

Older Work

- Senior PHP Developer - Advice Infrastructure Jan 2016 – Feb 2016
- Senior PHP Developer - Dragoonis Technologies Sep 2015 – Dec 2015
- Web Developer - Occa Design Limited May 2015 – June 2015
- Web Developer -- IES Limited Aug 2014 – Feb 2015
- Technical Lead -- 1-2-Let / All Agents Jun 2011 – Jul 2014
- Director -- PlayerReg Ltd 2011 - 2014
- Self Employed trading as Gifted Graphics 2001 – 2009
- IT Manager Trophy Centre Ltd 1997-2001